

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Alagarsamy Kupppamuthu

Address: 30 Avenue Road Belmont SM2 6JB

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer objects to the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment:Subject: Objection to Planning Application DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station, Dorset Road, Belmont, SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Place of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) with extensions and height increase

Dear Ms Davidson,

I write to formally object to planning application DM2025/01591 relating to the Ambulance Station on Dorset Road, Belmont.

My objection is based on material planning considerations, particularly the impact on highway safety, traffic congestion, parking stress, residential amenity, and community safety.

1. Traffic Generation and Highway Safety

The proposed change of use from a former ambulance station to a mixed-use Place of Worship (Class F1) and Community Hub (Class F2) will significantly intensify activity at the site.

Places of worship and community hubs typically generate concentrated peak-time traffic, particularly:

Evenings, afternoon and weekends

Religious gatherings and events

Community functions and celebrations

Dorset Road and the surrounding residential streets already experience congestion, particularly during school drop-off and pick-up times. The additional vehicle movements associated with this proposal would materially worsen:

Traffic congestion

Road safety conditions

Pedestrian safety

Access for emergency vehicles

This intensification is inappropriate in a predominantly residential area already operating under constrained highway conditions.

2. Parking Stress and Overspill

The area currently suffers from significant parking pressure, especially during school hours. The proposed development does not appear to provide sufficient on-site parking to accommodate peak attendance levels.

As a result, there is a high likelihood of:

Overspill parking into surrounding residential streets

Obstruction of driveways

Illegal or inconsiderate parking

Increased risk to children and parents walking to and from school

This would have a direct and ongoing adverse impact on residential amenity and highway safety.

3. Increased Footfall and Community Impact

The proposed use would draw visitors from outside the immediate neighbourhood. While community facilities are important, the scale and nature of this mixed-use proposal raise concern regarding:

Increased footfall in a quiet residential area

Congregation of large numbers of people before and after events

Noise and disturbance from gatherings

Loss of residential character

The regular presence of unfamiliar visitors and high turnover of attendees changes the character and dynamics of what is currently a relatively settled residential environment.

4. Scale and Massing

The proposal includes a part one, part two-storey extension and an increase in building height. This represents a substantial intensification compared to the previous use and may result in:

Overdevelopment of the site

Visual harm to the streetscape

Increased dominance within a residential context

The cumulative impact of increased scale and intensified use must be properly assessed.

Conclusion

In summary, the proposed development would:

Exacerbate existing traffic congestion

Create significant parking stress

Increase risks to school children and pedestrians

Harm residential amenity

Intensify use beyond what is appropriate for this location

For these reasons, I respectfully request that planning permission for application DM2025/01591 be refused.

Yours sincerely,
Alagarsamy Kuppamuthu
30 Avenue Road
SM2 6JB